

ening of corners relative to the centre of the image, an almost omnipresent fact of life in practical photography. This happens when their opaque edge gets in the way of light entering the lens, and the problem gets worse if we are stacking and using multiple filters.

Knowing all the pros and cons of using different types of filters is thus important before spending on these tiny tools. They generally come in two varieties- screw on and front filters with front ones being more flexible because they can be used on virtually any lens diameter, but are more of a hassle when in use as they have to be held by held in front of the lens when shooting. On the other hand, even though limited size matching is a disadvantage with them, screw-on filters are more popular as they can provide an air tight seal for increased protection, preventing any accidental motion relative to the lens during composure. To prevent vignetting, the height of the filters is also important, with ultra thin and other special filters being designed for use in wide angle lenses without blocking the edges. Manufacturers of lenses and filters have standardised on several different sets of sizes over the years, with threaded rounded filters being available among other varieties like square filters, rectangular filters, bayonet round ones, series mounting filters etc. Using filters is thus a foundation upon which to build by experience, and whatever may be your style and need, there will always be something new out there to try! 